Everybody Owns a Piece: The Integrated Run

Oct 31, 2026 · @Chris

This report was written on October 31, 2026, before the essay was updated. "The essay" and "essay now" here mean version 2 as it stood that day. The essay has since adopted the recommended version in "What I'd do" and the numbers from this run.

Bottom line

Run as one system, version 2 holds. No share sales, the transition fund never runs dry at the settings shown, and the check pays a little more than the essay says. The run turned up one new source of money and two weak spots.

- **New money.** The essay sends whatever the profit-share cap clips to the transition fund first and the citizen fund second, but no number in the essay counts it. It's about $64 billion a year with no growth. The transition fund needs about $9 billion of that, so roughly $54 billion, about $150 a person, flows into the check. In the AI boom it's $210 to $540 billion a year, because profit per worker climbs while jobs fall.
- **Year-three recession.** A 2008-style crash in the plan's third year cuts the fund's check 44 percent in one year. The fund is too young to have a real reserve. The whole check, carbon and ads included, falls 11 percent, and nothing is sold. The essay's 2008 test only ran on a full fund.
- **Joe's card payoff.** It saves him about $4,500 in interest, but it empties a small account right when he needs it, and the house slips three years.

Per person, year 30, today's dollars	Essay now	Integrated run
Fund check, no growth	about $970	about $1,110
Fund check, AI boom	about $3,350	about $3,900-4,800
Whole check (fund, carbon, ads), no growth	about $2,000	about $2,150
Joe's household, checks only	about $8,000	about $8,600

The boom range depends on what happens to pay. The low end is pay keeping pace with profit per worker, and the high end is pay frozen. Everything else is in the sections below.

What I'd do

It can be done. The money is real but modest. At no-growth numbers this is a dividend, nearly twice Alaska's $1,200 this year, not a living. The design that gets the most money with real safeties is the essay's, with two dials turned and one tax decision:

1. **Fill the quarter at 2.5 percent a year, not 1.5.** The fund is full in 12 years instead of 20, and the year-10 check is about $250 a person higher. Owners give up the same quarter, just sooner.
2. **Pay out 60 percent of the cash while the fund is filling, then 80.** That builds a start-up reserve, and it wipes out the year-three crash problem: in the same crash, the check doesn't fall at all. It costs about $70-110 a person in the early calm years, and it pays more later.
3. **Tax the fund and ad checks like Alaska's dividend; keep carbon tax-free.** A rough average rate of 10-12 percent brings back about $50 billion a year, most of the Treasury's no-growth gap. A plan that adds $80-300 billion a year to the deficit gets dismissed on that alone.
4. **Keep the half stake as a written-in stage two, not the default.** At 3 percent a year it nearly doubles the long-run check, but owners keep only half, and the day-one market hit roughly doubles with it.

Whole check per person, today's dollars	Year 5	Year 10	Year 20	Year 30	Year 30, AI boom	Worst year, crash in year 3	Worst year, crash on a full fund
Essay now (quarter at 1.5%)	$1,020	$1,320	$1,910	$2,150	$5,870	-11%	-7%
Recommended (quarter at 2.5%, 60% while filling)	$1,080	$1,570	$1,990	$2,160	$5,880	no drop	-7%
Stage two (half at 3%, 60% while filling)	$1,140	$1,690	$2,610	$3,130	$9,230	no drop	-9%

A family of four on the recommended plan gets about $8,600 a year by year 30 with no growth, and about $23,500 in the boom. No version sells a share to pay a check.

An economist with no stake would say three things about this, and none of them is a math failure. First, it's a real transfer from today's stock owners: a quarter of the big companies over twelve years, which pensions and 401(k)s feel. Second, the 10 percent profit share works like a 10 percent profit tax, so companies will try to book profit abroad or stay private, and the audit is the whole defense. Third, at no-growth numbers it's a floor, not an income. Where it gets big is the boom, the exact case the plan was built for.

What was run

The base is the round-two engine, unchanged where it was already checked. Run as it stood, it reproduces the essay's published numbers exactly: $972 and $3,361 for the fund at year 30, $223 at year 5, and Joe's house in year 23 with about $52,000 by year 40. New pieces were added on top of it. Every year runs all of them at once, the 500 biggest companies first, with 2021-2025 on real numbers and then out to year 100.

The rules, as the essay has them now:

1. Companies issue 1.5 percent of themselves a year into the citizen fund until it holds a quarter.
2. The profit share is 10 percent of pre-tax profit, split equally per head and capped at three months of each worker's own pay. All of the 10 points leave the company. Round two had taken 9.
3. What the cap clips goes to the transition fund first. The fund keeps two years of benefits in reserve and passes the rest to the citizen fund. If the clip falls short, it can take up to 2 of the 10 points.
4. The transition fund covers a laid-off worker for five years: a top-up worth 30 percent of his old pay while he's out of work, and half the gap if he takes a lower-paying job.
5. The citizen fund pays 80 percent of its five-year average cash, never more than the cash in plus the reserve. It keeps two years in reserve and pays out a fifth of anything above that each year.
6. Carbon: three-quarters of the fee is rebated and spendable. Ads: the round-two levy, about $200 a person.
7. Locked accounts: half of everything but carbon. A quarter of the balance, up to $2,000 an adult, is the cushion. The debt payoff can happen once every five years.

Some numbers had to be assumed, because no public source gives them. Each one was varied to see how much it matters:

Assumed	Set at	Tested at
Pay inside the S&P 500	$32,000 median in the lowest-value companies, rising to $220,000 in the highest	25% lower, 50% higher, rising 1-2% a year, keeping pace with profit
Pay cut for laid-off workers who earn less	25%	15% and 35%

Assumed	Set at	Tested at
Time out of work	half a year (three-quarters in a recession)	
What the locked money earns	3% after inflation	0%, 1%, 2%
Loss on the housing loans		0.1%, 0.3%, 1% a year

The displacement numbers are measured. BLS counted 7.4 million workers laid off from 2023 to 2025, about 1.5 percent of workers a year. 66 percent of the long-tenured ones were back at work, and about half of those earned less. A recession is set at 2.1 times as many layoffs, the 2007-2009 survey against 2023-2025.

Everything together

Here's one year of the whole plan's money in one place, in billions of today's dollars. The 500 biggest companies make about $2.5 trillion a year before tax. The plan takes a tenth of that as the profit share, plus new shares while the fund fills.

$ billions a year	No growth, year 10	No growth, year 20	AI boom, year 20
Companies' pre-tax profit	2,463	2,463	8,509
New shares into the fund (value)	789	27 (topping up)	95 (topping up)
Profit share, the whole 10 points	246	246	851
...paid to workers, under their caps	183	183	304
...clipped by the cap	64	64	547
Transition fund's bill	9	9	7
Clip passed on to the citizen fund	54	54	540
Citizen fund's cash in	253	409	1,766

$ billions a year	No growth, year 10	No growth, year 20	AI boom, year 20
Citizen fund's checks paid	202	369	1,417
Carbon fee collected / rebated	254 / 189	321 / 239	321 / 239
Ad levy	68	70	70

The worker count is the companies' whole headcount, about 30 million, falling to 22 million in the boom. The average profit share works out to about $6,200 a head, but it's lopsided. Joe's company pays him about $1,400, and a high-profit company hits the cap for most of its people. The fund's cash in runs ahead of its checks every year, and the difference is the reserve building. Nothing is ever sold to pay a check, in any run here.

The cap overflow

The overflow is the biggest thing the integrated run found, and the essay doesn't count it. The essay says where the clipped money goes. Every check in the essay was still computed as if the cap kept that money inside the companies.

How it works: a software company with few workers and big profits owes each worker far more than three months' pay. Take the companies with $20-50 million of value per employee. At their profit, the 10 percent comes to about $110,000 a head, while a $170,000 engineer's cap is about $42,000. Everything above the caps leaves the company anyway.

Clip passed on to the citizen fund, year 20	$ billions a year	Per person a year
No growth, pay as set	54	about $150
No growth, pay rising 1% a year	about 41 by year 30	about $110
AI boom, pay frozen	540	about $1,500
AI boom, pay rising 1% a year	508	about $1,360
AI boom, pay rising 2% a year	477	about $1,210
AI boom, pay keeping pace with profit per worker	213	about $590

This is the essay's own sentence, "the fewer people a company needs, the more of its 10 percent flows that way," with numbers on it. In the boom, unless pay keeps pace with profit, the overflow is a bigger check than the carbon and ad checks put together.

Two cautions. The overflow swings harder than dividends, because it's the top slice of profit. When profits fall 60 percent, the clip falls about 85 percent (the recession section shows it). And the size depends on pay inside high-profit companies, which no public table gives company by company. The direction is solid. The exact size is a range.

The transition fund, priced

The transition fund costs about $9 billion a year, and the clip brings in about seven times that. The 2-point backstop never gets touched in the no-growth run, the boom, or the year-three recession at the settings shown.

Per laid-off worker, the essay's rules cost about $20,400 on average over five years. That's a $9,000 top-up for the time out of work, plus half the pay gap for the people who come back earning less. About 457,000 workers a year get laid off from these companies, the BLS rate of about 1.5 percent applied to their 30 million people.

Case	Clip in	Bill	Backstop used
No growth	$64B	$9B	never
No growth, pay 50% higher and pay cuts 35%	$43B	$11B	never
AI boom, year 10 (jobs falling 3% a year)	$168B	$16B	never
Year-three recession, worst year	$9B	$19B	never; its own reserve covers it
Same recession, pay 50% higher and pay cuts 35%	$5B	$21B	2 years, at most 4% of workers' share

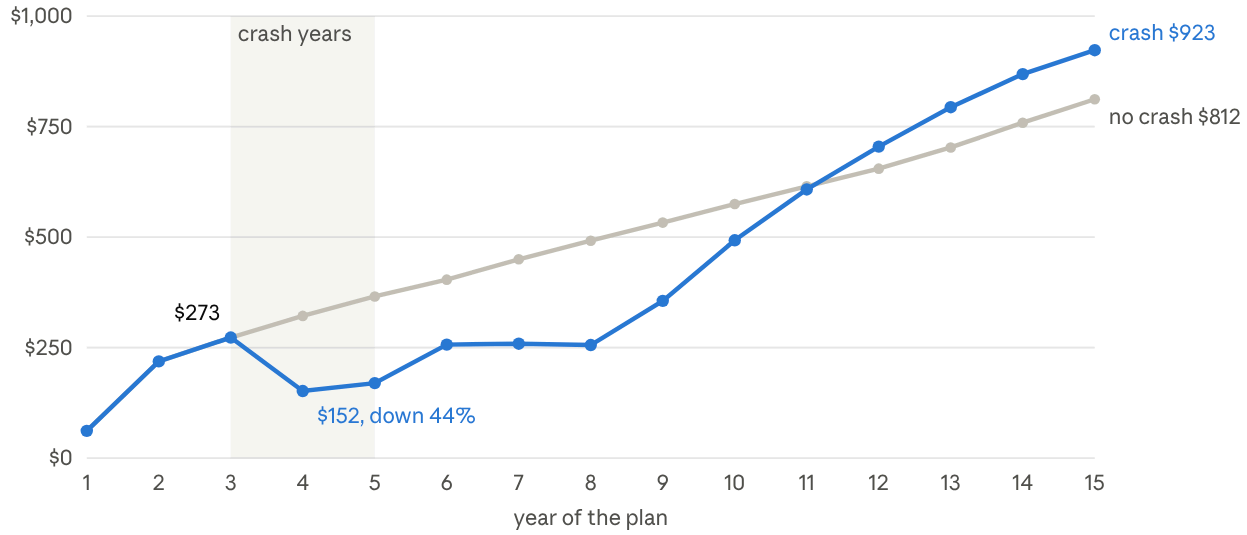
The worst case found takes about 4 percent of workers' share for two years. That would take Joe's $1,400 to about $1,350, not the fifth the essay warns about. The essay's line on the cost of the backstop is right as a ceiling, but the ceiling is far away. The first thing the essay said to run, how much the fund would owe in a bad year, comes to about twice its normal bill, and the fund's own two-year reserve carries it.

A recession in year three

A 2008-sized crash in the plan's third year is the hardest test in this run. The fund's check falls 44 percent the next year, and the whole check falls 11 percent, from about $990 to $880. Nothing is sold, and the transition fund never runs short.

A crash in year three cuts the fund check 44 percent the next year

Citizen fund check per person, today's dollars, plan starting fresh; 2008-2013 replayed from year 3



Integrated run, plan starting 2026; 2008-2013 S&P 500 cash and price changes replayed from 2028 (round-two engine's replay)

The hit lands this hard because the young fund has almost nothing behind it. It owns about 4 percent of the companies, and its reserve is about one year of checks. The companies' cash to owners falls 60 percent, the clip falls 85 percent, and the reserve is gone by year four. The rule "never more than cash in plus the reserve" then does its job. It cuts the check instead of selling shares. The check catches the calm path by year 11. After that it runs above it, which is the replay's quirk, not a gain: 2013's high payout rate is held from then on.

The same crash on a full fund, in year 26, takes the check down 15 percent in the worst year and 34 percent from peak to bottom, $1,100 to $730. The essay says 13.5 and about 30. The overflow makes the fund a little more cyclical. The whole check falls 7 percent in its worst year.

What this means for the essay: the line that the check never falls far is true for a full fund, but not for the first five years. If the early years matter, there are two ways to cover them. One is a start-up reserve, say a year of checks held back before the first payout. The other is a floor on the check paid from the carbon line's surplus. Neither has been run.

Joe's household

The overflow gets Joe's family into a house two years sooner, in year 21 instead of 23. The card payoff takes that back and then some. Everything is in today's dollars, using the essay's story: laid off at the end of year five, out of work for year six, back at the same pay in year seven at a company the plan doesn't cover.

Version	House	Built up by year 40	Spending money, years 6-10
Essay as published	year 23	about $52,000	not shown
With the overflow, no layoff extras	year 21	about $59,500	about $11,200
...plus the transition fund	year 21	about $59,500	about $24,700
...plus a $1,500 emergency from the cushion	year 22	about $56,900	about $24,700
...plus the card paid off from the account (the essay's full story)	year 25	about $51,800	about $22,400
Old world: same, but the card carried at 22%	year 22	about $56,900	about $17,200
New job pays 20% less ($36,000)	year 25	about $51,800	about $40,400

The transition fund is worth $13,500 to Joe in his year out of work. If the new job pays less, he gets another $18,000 over the next four years. It's all spendable, so it doesn't change the house year. It changes whether the family eats during the layoff.

The card payoff does what the essay says. It saves about $4,500 in interest, and counting spending and savings together the family comes out about $2,600 ahead. But the payoff comes in year six, when the account holds only about $5,800. After the emergency, the payoff takes about $3,200, everything above the cushion, and the house slips three years. That's a value call, not a math error: pay the 22 percent card now, or keep the down payment growing. One way to soften it is to allow the payoff only from the part of the balance above some floor, the way the cushion already works. That hasn't been run.

The kids leave home with about $5,900 and $8,200, up from the essay's $5,000 and $7,000.

The housing loans

If lending the locked money for housing earns less than 3 percent, the house comes later, a year or two for each point lost:

Locked money earns	Joe's house	Built up by year 40	Kids' accounts at 18
3% (the essay)	year 25	about $51,800	$5,900 and $8,200
2%	year 26	about $47,400	$5,600 and $7,600
1%	year 28	about $43,900	$5,300 and $7,100
0%	year 30	about $40,300	$5,000 and $6,700

This is the essay's full story for Joe, with the card payoff. The pool these loans draw on gets big fast: about $2 trillion by year 10, $6 trillion by year 20 and $12 trillion by year 30 at 3 percent. That's an upper bound, because it assumes nobody ever takes money out for a house or a retirement. For scale, U.S. home mortgages total about $13 trillion now, so the pool could become a large share of all home lending. Every 0.1 percent a year lost on loans costs the guarantee $1 billion per trillion lent. The government section prices that.

The government's net cost

The plan costs the Treasury about $60-85 billion a year with no growth. That's about a quarter of a percent of today's economy, before the housing guarantee. In the boom it's about $300 billion. Minus means money the government doesn't collect or has to pay.

$ billions a year	No growth, year 20	AI boom, year 20	Recession, worst year
Carbon: the kept quarter covers the taxes the fee displaces	0	0	0
Ad levy: other taxes it displaces	-17	-17	-17
Profit share: corporate tax lost on the whole 10 points	-52	-179	-21
Profit share: income and payroll tax on what workers get	+49	+82	+24

$ billions a year	No growth, year 20	AI boom, year 20	Recession, worst year
Transition fund: tax on its benefits	+1	+1	+2
Fund's stake: dividend and gains tax nobody pays on it	-19	-66	-2
Owners' smaller payouts: dividend and gains tax lost	-6	-22	-3
Protecting benefits: SSI not cut by the checks	-12	-34	-5
Protecting benefits: SNAP not cut by the checks	-24	-61	-11
Total before housing	**-81**	**-296**	**-33**

The housing guarantee comes on top. At 0.3 percent a year lost, it costs about $18 billion by year 20 and $35 billion by year 30 on the upper-bound pool. At 1 percent it's $59 billion and $116 billion. Loan losses are the one line here that could grow past everything else, so the guarantee needs its own rules: who decides the loans, and how much of the pool can go to housing.

Where the money goes in the boom: most of it is the corporate tax on the overflow. The overflow is deductible like pay, but it becomes untaxed checks instead of taxed wages. If the checks counted as taxable income, as Alaska's dividend does, most of that gap would close.

Two things push these numbers high. The profit and tax lines apply U.S. rates to the companies' worldwide profit and worldwide workers. And Medicaid, housing aid and the EITC aren't priced. The essay protects all of them, and they'd add to the benefits lines.

Stake size and speed

Run on its own, the half stake pays about what the essay's scaled-up row says, but only if it fills at 3 percent a year. At the essay's 1.5 percent, half takes 46 years to fill, and at year 30 it pays well under the essay's row.

Fund check per person	Full in	Year 10, no growth	Year 30, no growth	Year 30, boom	Old owners keep
Quarter at 1.5% (the essay)	year 20	$580	$1,110	$4,830	75%
Quarter at 2.5% (Altman's rate)	year 12	$860	$1,120	$4,840	75%
Half at 1.5%	year 46	$580	$1,470	$6,070	64% by year 30, then 50%
Half at 3%	year 23	$980	$2,060	$8,110	50%
Essay's half row (scaled, not run)			$1,900	$6,700	50%

The faster quarter matters early and only early. It pays about half again as much in year 10, and by year 30 it's the same check. That's the case for it if the layoffs come first.

The half stake at 3 percent beats the essay's scaled row, because the overflow doesn't scale down: it's the same $150 (or $1,500 in the boom) on top of either stake. Nothing is sold in any of these runs.

Capital raises

The capital-raise rule costs the checks almost nothing, because a fair-price raise doesn't take money from anyone. The company gets cash worth exactly the new shares. If the fund doesn't buy in, it owns a smaller slice of a bigger company, and the slice is worth the same.

The test was the AI boom with companies selling new stock for ten years after the fund is full, at 1 or 2 percent of their value a year:

After the fill, years 21-30	Fund's stake at year 30	Check at year 30	Check at year 40
No raises	25%	$4,830	$4,810
2% a year, fund never buys	20.5%	$4,820	$4,820
2% a year, fund buys with cash above its two-year floor	21.9%	$4,320	$4,970

After the fill, years 21-30	Fund's stake at year 30	Check at year 30	Check at year 40
1% a year, fund buys with cash above its two-year floor	24.0%	$4,360	$4,950

Buying in is a trade. While the raises last, the cash the fund spends comes out of the bonus it would have paid, so the check runs about 10 percent lower. Afterward it pays about 3 percent more, for good. Not buying keeps the check flat and lets the stake slip, which loses votes, not money.

Raises during the fill don't matter, because the fund keeps issuing until it reaches the quarter either way. The essay's wording, that the stake "can slip a little below a quarter when companies raise a lot of money," is right. The run says to add that the slip costs votes, not checks.

What the essay should change

The design holds. What needs updating is mostly numbers. Six edits follow from the run, plus three value calls.

1. **Count the overflow.** Year-30 fund check about $1,100 with no growth, whole check about $2,150, family of four about $8,600. In the boom, $3,900-4,800 depending on pay. "What it pays" can say plainly that the cap turns a profit boom into checks.
2. **Replace "the transition fund isn't in those numbers yet."** It's priced now: about $20,000 per laid-off worker over five years, about $9 billion a year, covered about seven times by the clip. The backstop's worst use found is about 4 percent of workers' share for two years.
3. **Joe:** the house in year 21 without the layoff extras, and year 25 with the card payoff. The kids leave with about $5,900 and $8,200. He gets $13,500 in his year out of work.
4. **The recession sentence:** a full fund falls about 15 percent in the worst year and a third from peak to bottom. A fund in its first five years can fall by nearly half, and the whole check by about a tenth.
5. **The half row:** "about $2,000 and $8,000 if it fills at 3 percent a year; at 1.5 it takes 46 years."
6. **"The numbers" paragraph:** take out the transition fund, the cushion and debt payoff, the housing loans, the faster schedule, capital raises and benefits protection, since all are run now. Add the government's net cost, about $80 billion a year before the housing

guarantee.

Three calls the numbers can't settle:

- A start-up reserve or an early floor on the check, to cover a crash in the first five years.
- A floor under the card payoff, so it can't empty a young account.
- Whether the fund's checks count as taxable income, like Alaska's. Yes would close most of the boom's tax gap. No keeps the check whole.

Still not in the numbers

- Pay inside high-profit companies. The overflow's size rests on it, and the run brackets it.
- How the locked accounts empty out for houses and retirements. The pool and the guarantee are upper bounds.
- Medicaid, housing aid and the EITC under the benefits protection.
- Whether companies change behavior: profit shifted abroad to dodge the 10 percent, or pay raised so more of it stays with their own people. The essay's AI auditors are the answer on paper. The run assumes the rules are followed.
- Private companies, and every listed company beyond the 500. The essay's 18 percent uplift for all listed companies hasn't been rerun with the overflow.

Sources and files

The engine and every number here are public at github.com/swensonator1/everybody-owns-a-piece. Run `python integrated.py` to reproduce them. All the round-two sources (S01-S55, R2-01 to R2-41) carry over. New in this run:

- Bureau of Labor Statistics, Worker Displacement: 2023-2025 (August 27, 2026)
- Social Security Administration, 2026 Annual Report of the SSI Program
- USDA Economic Research Service, SNAP participation, fiscal 2025
- National Employment Law Project, unemployment benefit amounts (2023 brief, 2021 data)
- Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Household Debt and Credit, 2026
- Federal Reserve, Consumer Credit G.19 (card interest rate, as cited in the essay)
- S&P Dow Jones Indices, S&P 500 as-reported earnings (round two's R2-08)

The numbers were checked by a second, independent review of the code. It confirmed the cap math against a simulation and confirmed that no money is lost or double counted in the transition fund. Its corrections are in: the comparisons use the same 10-point trim, the card comparison counts spending money, the recession averages over the years the plan has actually run, and capital raises add their cash to the company.